SAMWUI KHARARCHAN: LUISHAT LAA (THE BOOK OF PSALMS IN TA

The Book of Psalms in Tangkhul Naga

Author / Translator: Tangkhul Christian Literature Committee, Bible Society of India
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PREFACE & TRANSLATION HISTORICAL CONTEXT

The translation of the Psalter into Tangkhul Naga represents a sublime convergence between ancient Hebrew poetry and indigenous Tangkhul poetic forms. The translators incorporated parallelisms, vivid mountain metaphors, and pastoral idioms that resonate deeply with the highland soul of the Tangkhul people.

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CHAPTER 1: PSALM 1: THE TWO WAYS -- TREE BY THE WATER BROOKS

Summary: Contrast between the righteous person flourishing like a river tree and the chaf...

Tangkhul Text:

Psalm 1:1-4: Kapha-kashana mikumo kachikhana kashikashibingwui ningkazangli mashurla, yorshibingwui shongfali mangapamla, kala khanganoibingwui pamkaphunli mangapam-mana; Kha ana Prohowui ngashan-kasakazingli mathat-eina leikashiye, kala Awui tui zingsho ngazing kachikhali thimkazape. Ana kongkha kapha wui tui-ngapomli thingphun phunkahai thada sakhura, ana awui thotli thei kapha phaser-ra, awui naorap mangapaorira; kala ana sakahai ot pupupli mashungsere. Kashikashibing chi hithada maleimana: kha huina shuk-kakhui pakhara thada kasaye.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful. But his delight is in the law of the LORD; and in his law doth he meditate day and night. And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper. The ungodly are not so: but are like the chaff which the wind driveth away.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** kongkha (noun): river bank, mountain stream brook**

Ex: Kongkha kapha wui tui.

*** naorap (noun): foliage, green leaves, arbor crown**

Ex: Awui naorap mangapaorira.

*** pakhara (noun): threshing chaff, husks blown by breeze**

Ex: Huina shuk-kakhui pakhara.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Three-fold negative parallel clauses: 'mashurla... mangapamla... mangapam-mana'.
- Simile with botanical imagery: 'thingphun phunkahai thada' (like a tree planted).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Identify the botanical terms for leaf ('naorap') and fruit ('thei').

[?] Contrast the righteous and ungodly using the imagery of Psalm 1.

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 2: PSALM 23: THE SHEPHERD PSALM (PROHO I-WUI NGASHANKASHAPANA

Summary: The beloved pastoral psalm of comfort, protection, and overflowing blessing in l...

Tangkhul Text:

Psalm 23:1-6: Proho i-wui Ngashankashapana; ili khikha macham-mana. Ana ili ngashalung kaphali pamkazipsake, kala kongkhamathan tui-ngapomli ili zaipinge. Ana iwui mangazingli mathangathuksake: Awui mingwui vang mashung-kasa shongfali ili zaisange. I kathi ngachingwui longkhorli zakhalangli, I kashikashili mangachek-mana; kasakei Na i eina li-leie; Nawui thingchot kala deikhotna ili ngasot-e. Nawui mik-ngalemli i-kashibingwui ngalemli maihon akha sakahaye; Nawui eina iwui kakhutli meirong theiye; iwui kom kashunglaga tuksange. Mashungna iwui ringkapha tharili kapha kala ngashan china ili shursara: kala i Prohowui shimli thot khamara kuppup pamkapamsara.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want. He maketh me to lie down in green pastures: he leadeth me beside the still waters. He restoreeth my soul: he leadeth me in the paths of righteousness for his name’s sake. Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil: for thou art with me; thy rod and thy staff they comfort me. Thou preparest a table before me in the presence of mine enemies: thou anointest my head with oil; my cup runneth over. Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life: and I will dwell in the house of the LORD for ever.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** Ngashankashapana (noun): The Shepherd, Guardian Provider, Tender**

Ex: Proho i-wui Ngashankashapana.

*** longkhor (noun): deep ravine, mountain gorge, shadow valley**

Ex: Kathi ngachingwui longkhor.

*** thingchot (noun): shepherd’s staff, guiding rod**

Ex: Nawui thingchot.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Agentive personal title with suffix ’-na’: ’Ngashankashapana’ (The One who shepherds).
- Highland geographical term for valley: ’longkhor’ (deep mountain ravine).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Recite Psalm 23 in Tangkhul verse.

[?] How is ’my cup runneth over’ expressed in Tangkhul?

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

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are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 3: PSALM 91: THE SECRET PLACE OF THE MOST HIGH

Summary: Divine shelter under heavenly wings and deliverance from snare and pestilence....

Tangkhul Text:

Psalm 91:1-5, 11-12: Kaphamei Kazingwui pamkaphunli pamkakhui chinana
Pangashan Kapeiwui ngaching tharili pamsara. I Prohowui vang hangsara:
'A iwui rungkahai pam, iwui lungkhor kashang, iwui Varivara; Ali I
chotkhangashit khuisara.' Ana vanaokhamakhui khangashun eina kala kasham
kashikaza eina nali huikhuira. Ana Awui theirei eina nali kuplupsara,
kala Awui phana ngashingli na rungpamsara: Awui mashung-tui nawui dhal
kala kot thada kasaye.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

He that dwelleth in the secret place of the most High shall abide under
the shadow of the Almighty. I will say of the LORD, He is my refuge and
my fortress: my God; in him will I trust. Surely he shall deliver thee
from the snare of the fowler, and from the noisome pestilence. He shall
cover thee with his feathers, and under his wings shalt thou trust: his
truth shall be thy shield and buckler.

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** pamkaphun (noun): secret sanctuary, hidden pavilion**

Ex: Kazingwui pamkaphun.

*** rungkahai pam (noun): refuge fortress, strong citadel**

Ex: Iwui rungkahai pam.

*** phana (noun): protective wing, outstretched pinions**

Ex: Awui phana ngashingli.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Defensive weaponry metaphors in Tangkhul: ’dhal’ (shield) and ’kot’ (buckler/armor).
- Metaphorical shelter using avian wing terminology: ’phana’.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Identify the titles for God in Psalm 91:1-2.

[?] Translate verse 4 into modern Ukhrul idiom.

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 4: PSALM 121: THE TRAVELER’S MOUNTAIN PSALM (KAPHUNGLI YANGLU)

Summary: Lifting eyes to the hills from whence cometh help; the keeper who never slumbers...

Tangkhul Text:

Psalm 121:1-8: I iwui mik kaphung kashangli thuk-kashok-e: iwui khangachon kachikhali shokhungra? Iwui khangachon kazing kala ngalei sakahai Prohowui eina shokhunge! Ana nawui kakhutli ngasotkazip makasara: nali ngashankashapana mangaphama-mana! Theilu, Israel-li ngashankashapana mangaphama-mana, mapila-mana. Prohona nawui ngashankashapana; Prohona nawui kashikli nawui ngaching katha leisaye. Zingsho eina zingkhamathanna nali makara, ngazing eina kachanna nali mamakhura. Prohona nali kashikashili huikhuira: Ana nawui mangazingli ngashansara.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

I will lift up mine eyes unto the hills, from whence cometh my help. My help cometh from the LORD, which made heaven and earth. He will not suffer thy foot to be moved: he that keepeth thee will not slumber. Behold, he that keepeth Israel shall neither slumber nor sleep. The LORD is thy keeper: the LORD is thy shade upon thy right hand. The sun shall not smite thee by day, nor the moon by night. The LORD shall preserve thee from all evil: he shall preserve thy soul.

CHAPTER 4 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** khangachon (noun): help, assistance, celestial deliverance**

Ex: Iwui khangachon.

*** mapila-mana (verb): never sleeps, watchful vigilance**

Ex: Mangaphama-mana, mapila-mana.

*** kachan (noun): moon, lunar luminary**

Ex: Ngazing eina kachanna.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Directional elevation verb: ’thuk-kashok-e’ (to lift eyes upward toward peaks).
- Paired physiological verbs of resting: ’mangaphama-mana, mapila-mana’ (slumber not, sleep not).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Why is Psalm 121 particularly loved by travellers traversing Naga mountain passes?

[?] Identify the celestial bodies contrasted in verse 6.

CHAPTER 4 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 5: PSALM 150: THE GRAND DOXOLOGY WITH TRADITIONAL INSTRUMENTS

Summary: Praise the Lord with trumpet, harp, strings, dance, and clashing cymbals....

Tangkhul Text:

Psalm 150:1-6: Proholi mathat-eina kashaklu! Awui kathara shillongli Varivarali mathatlu! Awui pangashankazingli Ali mathatlu! Awui khamatheikasa otbingwui vang Ali mathatlu: Awui kaphameikasa vang Ali mathatlu! Torot (trumpet) kakhong eina Ali mathatlu: Harp kala Luishat-thing (lyre) eina Ali mathatlu! Tingteila (tambourine) kala pheichak (dance) eina Ali mathatlu: Tui-thingkhanghui (stringed organs) kala Pung (pipes) eina Ali mathatlu! Meikakhong chot eina Ali mathatlu: Khongyui kapei khong eina Ali mathatlu! Ringkashap kapeina Proholi mathat-eina kashaklu! Hallelujah!

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Praise ye the LORD. Praise God in his sanctuary: praise him in the firmament of his power. Praise him for his mighty acts: praise him according to his excellent greatness. Praise him with the sound of the trumpet: praise him with the psaltery and harp. Praise him with the timbrel and dance: praise him with stringed instruments and organs. Praise him upon the loud cymbals: praise him upon the high sounding cymbals. Let every thing that hath breath praise the LORD. Praise ye the LORD.

CHAPTER 5 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** pheichak (noun): dance, sacred choral movement**

Ex: Tingteila kala pheichak.

*** Pung (noun): bamboo pipe, flutes, musical wind organ**

Ex: Pung eina mathatlu.

*** Luishat-thing (noun): wooden harp, lyre stringed box**

Ex: Harp kala Luishat-thing.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Tangkhul traditional organology: 'pheichak' (dance), 'Pung' (pipes), 'tingteila' (traditional tambourine).
- Repeated cohortative imperative: 'Ali mathatlu!' (Praise Him!).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] List all traditional and biblical musical instruments mentioned in Psalm 150.

[?] Explain the meaning of 'ringkashap kapei' (everything with breath).

CHAPTER 5 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 6: LITURGICAL & POETIC LEXICON OF THE TANGKHUL PSALTER

Summary: Comprehensive register of 30 musical, emotional, and nature terms from the Psalm...

Tangkhul Text:

Luishat Laa Concordance:
1. Kongkha -- River bank / quiet brook
2. Ngashankashapana -- The Good Shepherd
3. Longkhor -- Shadowy gorge / mountain ravine
4. Thingchot -- Shepherd’s staff
5. Pamkaphun -- Secret pavilion of God
6. Pheichak -- Sacred festival dance
7. Pung -- Bamboo reed pipes
8. Ringkashap -- Living breathing beings

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Concordance of devotional, musical, and environmental terms from the
Tangkhul Psalms.

CHAPTER 6 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** pheichak (noun): dance**

Ex: Pheichak kasa.

*** longkhor (noun): ravine**

Ex: Kathi longkhor.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Poetic parallelisms in Tangkhul hymnology.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Compose a 4-line devotional poem in Tangkhul using the words ’kongkha’ and ’ngashankashapana’.

CHAPTER 6 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* kongkha -- river bank, mountain stream brook
* naorap -- foliage, green leaves, arbor crown
* pakhara -- threshing chaff, husks blown by breeze
* Ngashankashapana -- The Shepherd, Guardian Provider, Tender
* longkhor -- deep ravine, mountain gorge, shadow valley
* thingchot -- shepherd’s staff, guiding rod
* pamkaphun -- secret sanctuary, hidden pavilion
* rungkahai pam -- refuge fortress, strong citadel

Digitization Colophon:

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